ROLEEDGE · CONSULTING PREP

Consulting Prep Playbook

Frameworks, Tools, and Practice to Crack MBB and Big 4 Interviews

13	11	Print
SECTIONS	EXERCISES	WITH SPACE TO WRITE

How to use this guide: print it, work through it in order, and write in the spaces. Every exercise has room for your answers, and you can print extra copies of any page.

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From **RoleEdge**, founded by Mayank Kapoor, former Manager at Bain & Company and Warwick MBA. Free to use and share.

Why Consulting Interviews Are Unique

Consulting firms test how you **think, structure, and communicate.** Unlike other industries, consulting interviews combine **business problem-solving** with **behavioral storytelling.**

Recruiters look for:

- Structured thinking (MECE).
- Clarity in communication.
- Comfort with ambiguity.
- Quick math skills.
- Strong presence under pressure.

EXERCISE

Write 2 reasons why consulting appeals to you as a career path.

1. _____

2. _____

STEP 1

Master the Consulting Mindset

Consultants are trained to:

- Break down complex problems into simple parts.
- Focus on impact, not activity.
- Communicate with clarity in every slide or sentence.

You must approach every case like a consultant: structured, hypothesis-driven, and concise.

REFLECTION

When solving problems, do you jump to solutions or pause to structure?

_____

_____

_____

_____

STEP 2

Learn the Core Frameworks

Frameworks are scaffolds, not crutches. The must-know ones are:

- **Profitability:** Revenue vs cost breakdown.
- **Market Entry:** Market, Competition, Customer, Company.
- **M&A:** Synergies, risks, valuation.
- **Operations:** Efficiency, bottlenecks.
- **4Ps/7Ps:** Marketing-driven cases.

EXERCISE

Write a MECE breakdown for: “Client wants to launch a new digital bank.”

STEP 3

Market Sizing & Guesstimates

Market sizing shows logical structure. Example: “Estimate the market for EV chargers in India.”

- Cars in India → % EV → Chargers needed per EV → Price per charger.

The goal isn’t accuracy—it’s **structure.**

EXERCISE

Pick a consumer product and estimate its annual market size in your city.

STEP 4

Profitability Cases

Profit drops = check:

- **Revenues:** Price, volume, mix.
- **Costs:** Fixed, variable, supply chain.

MINI CASE

A hotel's profits are down despite steady occupancy. How do you diagnose?

STEP 5

Market Entry & Growth Strategy Cases

Clients want growth. Market entry analysis covers:

- Market size, growth potential.
- Competitive intensity.
- Client's strengths & weaknesses.
- Entry mode: Build, Buy, Partner.

MINI CASE

A US pizza chain wants to enter India. How do you structure?

STEP 6

M&A & Private Equity Cases

PE/M&A cases test valuation + synergies.

- Revenue synergies (cross-selling).
- Cost synergies (shared supply chains).
- Risks (integration, culture).

MINI CASE

A telecom company wants to acquire a smaller competitor. How do you assess?

STEP 7

Operations & Supply Chain Cases

Ops = efficiency.

- Inputs → Process → Outputs.
- Bottlenecks, utilization, lean methods.

MINI CASE

A factory runs at 60% capacity. What levers can improve throughput?

STEP 8

Public Sector & Non-Profit Cases

Many firms (BCG, Dalberg, Deloitte) do social sector projects. Framework still applies:

- Diagnose issue.
- Define impact metrics (access, efficiency).
- Build sustainable models.

MINI CASE

An NGO wants to increase vaccination rates. How do you structure?

Case Math: Margins, Breakevens, CAGR

Math shows rigor.

- Profit Margin = Profit ÷ Revenue.
- Breakeven = Fixed Costs ÷ Contribution Margin.
- CAGR = (End/Start)^(1/n) – 1.

EXERCISE

A client grows revenue from $100M to $200M in 4 years. What's the CAGR? (Answer: about 19%.)

Fit/Personal Experience Interview (PEI) Preparation

Firms such as McKinsey give the **Personal Experience Interview (PEI)** as much weight as the case. Common questions:

- Tell me about a time you led a team.
- Tell me about a time you solved a conflict.
- Tell me about a failure.

Framework: STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result).

EXERCISE

Write 1 leadership story using STAR.

	My leadership story
Situation	
Task	
Action	
Result	

EXAMPLE

Worked examples

An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.

Strategy firm offer: Rohan practised 50+ cases with peers, refined his PEI stories and drilled case math until it was automatic. He received a business analyst offer.

Big Four offer: Sneha rewrote her resume with quantified impact, practised profitability cases and guesstimates, and landed a strategy analyst role.

> LESSON
> Prep = consistency, not shortcuts.

Common Mistakes and a 12-Week Plan

- ✕ Jumping to solutions without structure.
- ✕ Over-relying on memorized frameworks.
- ✕ Neglecting PEI.

Your plan

When	Focus	My actions
Weeks 1–4	Framework drills + guesstimates.	
Weeks 5–8	Profitability + market entry mocks.	
Weeks 9–12	Full mock interviews + PEI stories.	

My notes

NEXT STEP

Want someone to check your work?

Bring this guide to a free call with RoleEdge. We'll go through your answers and help you plan what comes next.

Book a free call at roleedge.com/book